Modern survey tools used by geographers for map making.

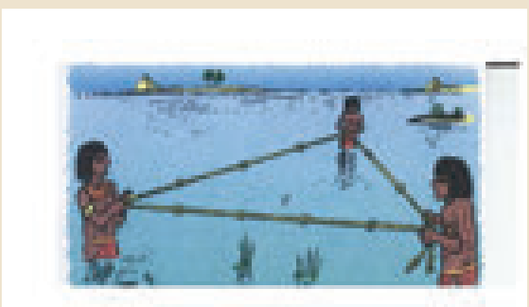






Early History of Surveying: In Egypt, surveyors were called 'rope stretchers' because they used ropes to measure distances.

The Egyptian 'Rope Stretchers'



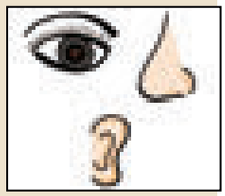
7.2 Remote Sensing as a Source of Map Data

Remote Sensing refers to the observation and measurement of earthly objects without touching them.

'**Remote**' means far away and '**Sensing**' means observing or collecting information. Remote sensing means acquiring information of things/places from a distance, using a variety of tools and methods.



We operate three remote sensing organs in our body.



a) Eyes -sense of sight

b) Nose - sense of smell

c) Ear – Sense of hearing

Remote sensing has a long history, dating back from the use of cameras carried by balloons and pigeons in the 18th and 19th centuries. During the 20th century, airborne photographs and satellite remote sensing developed swiftly.

7.2.1. Aerial photography

Aerial photography refers to the technique of obtaining information about places or objects or phenomena with the help of photographs taken using cameras mounted on **low flying birds, balloons, helicopters, aeroplanes and drones.** The aerial photographs are captured continuously with a time gap of 10-30 seconds at a fixed height. Each photo will have a slight overlap of the area in the preceding photo. By making a mosaic of all the photos excluding the overlapping areas, a stereoscopic (3D) image of the study area can be produced.



Felix Nadar was a French photographer, journalist, novelist and balloonist. In 1858, he became the first person to take aerial photographs. He took his first photograph in 1853 and pioneered the use of artificial lighting in photography, working in the catacombs of Paris. Around 1863, Nadar built a huge (6000 m^3) balloon named Le Géant ('The Giant').



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